



ITIL® (Version 5) Release Notes

Global Best Practice



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Published by PeopleCert International Limited
Published in Cyprus
Publication printed in Greece or reproduced electronically in Greece

Version 5.0 (February 2026)

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Scope

- This document aims to help you **understand the key changes from ITIL 4 to the new ITIL (Version 5)**.

Introduction to ITIL (Version 5)

- ITIL has a **strong global brand**, adopted and adapted by organizations and professionals worldwide, thanks to the continuous involvement, active engagement, and **co-creation with our community**.
- While we recognize that parts of the ecosystem may remain aligned to **earlier ITIL versions**, this continued adoption is a testament to the **stickiness of the ITIL brand**.
- ITIL (Version 5) provides a new opportunity to further expand ITIL's global reach and demonstrate how it can truly empower organizations and people to **lead transformation with confidence**.
- ITIL has consistently been the **Global Best Practice Framework** across its successive focus areas, evolving from IT Service Management (ITSM) to Service Management (SM) and Digital Transformation. While **ITSM and SM (including Enterprise SM) remain our long-established leading areas**, we are **expanding the ITIL scope and positioning as the Global Best Practice framework for Digital Product and Service Management in the AI-driven world**.
- **Digital Product and Service Management:** In today's AI-driven world, all products and services are influenced by digital technologies, either directly or indirectly. The term 'digital products and services' captures the full spectrum of digital relevance; **from traditionally non-digital products** enabled or supported by digital technology during their lifecycle (e.g. a pen designed or produced using digital technologies), **to technology-enabled products** (e.g. a smartphone enabled by its operating system and installed applications), and **further to products that are fully digital by nature** (e.g. software). **Digital services** are delivered through, and are fundamentally dependent on, these **digital products**. As such, digital products and services must be **approached holistically**. The new ITIL **unifies** how organisations design, manage, and continuously improve **digital products and services** – enabling **superior experiences, coherent strategies, and growth**.
- **Fundamental ITIL concepts and principles remain the same, slightly adjusted or simply repositioned in this new context.**
- **A relevant example is the positioning of the ITIL Management Practices.** All 34 ITIL Management Practices remain unchanged and continue to sit at the core of the ITIL framework as essential value enablers. However, in the new ITIL Foundation, the **focus has shifted away from memorizing knowledge related to individual practices towards understanding their purpose, structure, benefits, and their role within the ITIL Value System** – empowering organizations and professionals to use them **confidently from day one to drive growth**.

What's new in ITIL (Version 5)

ITIL 4 and ITIL (Version 5) | Key ITIL Concepts

The concepts in this table are presented in the same order as they appear in the Official Book.

Key ITIL Concepts	ITIL 4	ITIL (Version 5)	Comment
Scope of the ITIL framework	IT Service Management (management of the full lifecycle of IT services) and Digital Transformation.	ITSM and Service Management, expanded to include Digital Product and Service Management, covering the full lifecycle of digital products and services.	From IT Service Management, to Service Management (including Enterprise Service Management), expanded to include Digital Product and Service Management.
Products and services	Definitions of products and services: products provide capabilities, services enable value co-creation based on these capabilities.		N/A
Digital products and services	N/A	Specific definitions derived from the product and service definitions.	The term 'digital products and services' captures the full spectrum of digital relevance; from traditionally non-digital products enabled or supported by digital technology during their lifecycle (e.g. a pen designed or produced using digital technologies), to technology-enabled products (e.g. a smartphone enabled by its operating system and installed applications), and further to products that are fully digital by nature (e.g. software).
Key roles in value co-creation	Service providers and service consumers.	Product vendors, service providers, service consumers.	The roles of product vendor and service provider can be played by one organization or by different organizations.
Service consumer roles	Sponsor, Customer, User.		N/A
Service quality and service level characteristics	Utility, warranty, experience.	Utility, warranty, experience, sustainability.	Sustainability is added as a key characteristic of service quality.
Service interactions	Access to resources, transfer of goods, service actions.		No changes; the key role of access to resources for digital services is emphasized.
Types of service relationships	Basic, cooperative, collaborative (partnership).		N/A
Governance	Evaluate – direct – monitor.	Evaluate – direct – monitor – engage stakeholders.	The description is updated to reflect ISO/IEC 38500:2024 – Information technology – Governance of IT for the organization.

Key ITIL Concepts	ITIL 4	ITIL (Version 5)	Comment
ITIL Four Dimensions	The ITIL four dimensions of service management ; external PESTLE factors.	The ITIL Four dimensions of Product and Service Management ; external PESTLE factors.	Reviewed descriptions. The ITIL AI Capability Model is added to the 'Information and Technology' dimension.
ITIL Guiding Principles	Seven Guiding Principles.		Descriptions are clarified; AI is added to the 'how to apply the principle' sections.
ITIL Practices	34 practices grouped in three groups: general, service, and technical.	Same 34 practices grouped in two groups: general, and 'product and service management practices'.	The 34 ITIL Official Practice Guides are aligned with the new ITIL (available with PeopleCert Plus). Minor updates expected. Integrated across the new ITIL Modules and learning experience.
ITIL Value Streams	Basic definitions.		Clarified definitions, better link to the value chain, value stream mapping recommendations in Appendix E of the Official Book.

ITIL 4 and ITIL (Version 5) | Key ITIL Models

The models in this table are presented in the same order as they appear in the Official Book.

Key ITIL Models	ITIL 4	ITIL (Version 5)	Comment
ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle Model	N/A	The ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle Model unifies digital product and service in one model. Lifecycle management activities included: • Discover • Design • Acquire • Build • Transition • Operate • Deliver • Support.	To manage digital products and services throughout their shared lifecycle, organizations perform the lifecycle management activities . These activities enable and support the lifecycle but are not performed in a fixed sequence; this varies depending on the product and service architecture and organizational context . They are combined according to the context to form value chains .

Key ITIL Models	ITIL 4	ITIL (Version 5)	Comment
Value Chain	Service Value Chain is at the centre of the ITIL Service Value System. Activities included: • Plan • Engage • Design & Transition • Obtain/Build • Deliver & Support • Improve	A value chain is an entire set of activities that enables value through the provision of a product or service. Activities included (as in the ITIL Lifecycle Model): • Discover • Design • Acquire • Build • Transition • Operate • Deliver • Support	The activities are linked to the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle Model lifecycle management activities and presented as stepping stones, with all or some of them forming the organization's value chain. Each value chain activity is described in a uniform way and mapped to enabling and supporting practices.
ITIL Value System	ITIL Service Value System components and positioning: 1. Guiding Principles 2. Governance 3. (Service) Value Chain 4. Practices 5. Continual Improvement	ITIL Value System components and positioning: 1. ITIL Guiding Principles 2. Governance 3. ITIL Value Chain 4. Management Practices 5. The ITIL Continual Improvement Model	No structural changes. Service value chain is now value chain. It strengthens the ITIL Value System with a clearer modular value chain model.
ITIL Continual Improvement Model	7 steps: 1. what is the vision 2. where are we now 3. where do we want to be 4. how do we get there 5. take action 6. did we get there 7. how do we keep the momentum going	7 steps (updated): 1. what is the vision 2. where are we now 3. where do we want to be 4. how do we get there 5. take action 6. are we getting there 7. how do we keep the improvements relevant	Apart from the updated names of the steps, all steps are described from both 'clear' and 'discovery' perspectives stressing the importance of experimentation when the destination and/or steps are not clear.
ITIL Service Journey Model	The ITIL Service Journey Model describes the steps of the service journey and the key tasks of the service consumer and service provider.		Brief explanation of the journey shared by service providers and service consumers.
ITIL AI Capability Model	N/A	New. Describes AI's key functional capabilities.	-

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